

Knowledge Desk

Your quick-reference for building courses — keep this open while you work.

This is the "look it up fast" companion to your one-page getting-started guide. It covers the questions that come up while you're actually building — quizzes, videos, sharing courses, and the little things that save time. You can't break anything, so explore freely.

1 The essentials at a glance

Site <https://ncysa-learn.onrender.com>

Your login DA@ncsoccer.org · password from Jeremy

You are a Course Designer — you build courses; you won't see learner records or the staff dashboard (that's by design, not a glitch).

Everything auto-saves There's no "publish" button. A course goes live for its audience as soon as it has a lesson.

2 Building a course, step by step

1. **Sign in** → you land on your **Course Designer** page.
2. **+ New course** → give it a Title, Tagline, short Description, a Badge label, and pick the **Audience**.
3. **+ Add lesson** → choose a type (Reading, Video, or Exam/Quiz) and fill it in. Add as many as you like.
4. That's it — it saves as you go.

Choosing the audience

Audience	Who sees it
Everyone	Coaches + shown in staff training
Coaches only	Coaches
Referees only	Referees
Staff training	Only the internal staff area

Order matters

Lessons appear to learners in the order you add them, and each one unlocks only after the previous is finished. Put them in the sequence you want people to move through.

3 Quizzes — two ways, and when to use each

This is the most common question, so here it is clearly.

Built-in quiz — use this for anything graded or required

- Add an **Exam / Quiz** lesson, set a **pass mark** (e.g. 80%), type your questions, and click the circle next to the correct answer.
- The app **grades it automatically**, only lets a learner finish if they pass, and unlimited retakes are allowed.
- Passing is what **issues the certificate** and **records the completion for NCYSA**. This is the whole point of the platform — verified, tracked completion.

Google Form / JotForm — works, but the app can't see the results

You *can* embed a Google Form or JotForm inside a **Reading** lesson (paste its "embed" code into the content box and it'll display right in the course). But keep in mind:

- The platform **can't grade it or see the score** — responses go to your Google/JotForm inbox, not the learner's record.
- It **can't require a passing grade** to move on, and it **won't trigger the certificate**.
- Great for **surveys, feedback, or ungraded practice** — not for the graded test that counts.

Rule of thumb

If it needs to count toward certification → built-in quiz. If it's an optional survey or you just want to collect responses → embed a Form.

4 Adding a video

The video lesson asks for a **link**, not a file upload. For now:

1. In your **WordPress dashboard**, open **Media** (left sidebar, same area as Events) → **Add New** → upload your video.
2. Click the uploaded video and **copy its File URL**.
3. Back in NCYSA Learn, paste it into the **Video URL (MP4)** field and set the **Duration (seconds)**.

Anti-skip is automatic

The "must-watch" time fills in for you (a couple seconds short of the full length), so learners actually have to watch — fast-forwarding snaps back.

Coming later

To keep the WordPress media library tidy, we'll switch to a shared

Dropbox

folder for videos. Jeremy will share it with you when it's ready — until then, WordPress is perfect.

5 Sharing a course with learners

Every course has its own link — no export step needed.

1. Open the course in your browser.
2. **Copy the web address** straight from the address bar (it looks like `...onrender.com/#/course/your-course-name`).
3. Send that link. When someone clicks it, the app walks them through it: create a free account, enroll, complete the lessons in order, take the quiz, and get their certificate — all inside the app, and NCYSA is notified automatically.

You can also just share the main site address and let people browse the catalog to find their course.

6 A good habit: take your own course

After you build a course, sign out and go through it as a learner (create a test account with any email). You'll see exactly what learners see — the video gate, the quiz, the certificate — and catch anything that feels off before you share it.

7 Quick FAQ

Q: The site took a while to load the first time — is it broken?

A: No. On the first visit after a quiet period the server takes ~40–50 seconds to wake up, then it's fast. Give it a moment.

Q: I don't see the dashboard or learner records.

A: Correct — course designers don't have access to those. You focus on building; NCYSA staff handle records.

Q: Do I need to click "publish" or "save"?

A: No. Everything saves automatically as you add it. A course is live for its audience once it has at least one lesson.

Q: Can I edit a course after learners have started it?

A: Yes — open it and adjust lessons anytime. New learners see the updated version.

Q: What formats can the reading lessons handle?

A: Plain text with basic formatting, and you can paste an embed code (like a Google Form) if you want.

Q: Who do I contact if I'm stuck?

A: Jeremy — he can sort out logins, passwords, and anything platform-related.

NCYSA Learn — Course Designer reference. Questions or changes? Reach out to Jeremy.